Berlin, where he hoped to convince Hitler and the Nazis to support India's struggle for independence (even though he personally disapproved of the Nazis' racist ideology). Receiving only limited support from them, in 1943 Bose decided to reach out to the Japanese for help, and embarked on a daredevil journey via submarine and airplane. Once back in Asia, he founded the Azad Hind Fauj (Indian National Army) and trained Indian soldiers and workers whom he convinced to join his cause.



Bose's strong belief in the equality of men and women led him to form the very first all-female regiment anywhere in the world. Named after the Rani of Jhansi, it was commanded by Lakshmi Sahgal.

AZAD HIND GOVERNMENT

Bose formed the Azad Hind government in October 1943 in Singapore. It had its own currency, court and army (the INA). The INA fought British Indian Army troops in Burma with the support of the Japanese, and even reached Kohima and Imphal in the north-east of India before suffering a crushing defeat.